

CBAM Exporter Readiness Checklist

40-point self-assessment for exporters of CBAM-covered goods into the EU. Tick each item when the underlying evidence exists — not when it is planned.

A. Product & Scope (6)

#	Check	Evidence / Notes
1	Every exported product classified against EU CN codes; CBAM-covered vs not determined per product	
2	Downstream/derived products checked (some fall in scope even when the base product does not)	
3	Precursor goods entering the production process identified (their embedded emissions must be counted)	
4	EU customers identified: who acts as importer of record (declarant)?	
5	UK CBAM (Jan 2027) coverage assessed separately — scope differs from EU	
6	Annual tonnage and value per covered CN code compiled	

B. Embedded Emissions Data (10)

#	Check	Evidence / Notes
7	Installation-level production process mapped (process flow with all emission sources)	
8	District heating / fuel / electricity consumption metered at installation level	
9	Product-level allocation rules defined (allocation to product vs co-products)	
10	Actual embedded emissions calculable (vs relying on default values)	
11	Emission factors cited with source and vintage for every fuel/material	
12	Electricity: grid factor source documented (country-specific, correct vintage)	
13	Precursor emissions included where required by the implementing regulation	
14	Internal QC: second person re-performs the calculation independently	
15	Data chain documented: source document to final number, reproducible	
16	Consistency checked between CBAM figures and company GHG inventory	

C. Verification Readiness (8)

#	Check	Evidence / Notes
17	Evidence pack assembled (invoices, logbooks, meter records, calc files)	
18	Calculation files version-controlled with named owners	
19	Data collection SOP written (who records what, when, from where)	
20	Pre-verification gap assessment done (internal or external)	
21	Verification body identified / engaged	
22	Findings from gap assessment resolved or scheduled	
23	Authorised signatory identified for declarations	
24	Filing calendar known (quarterly/annual deadlines for the EU declarant)	

D. Commercial & Contract (6)

#	Check	Evidence / Notes
25	CBAM cost exposure quantified at current EU ETS price and phase-out share	
26	Forward contracts reviewed for CBAM liability allocation clauses	
27	Price-negotiation brief prepared (verified intensity vs defaults)	
28	Data-sharing terms with EU customers agreed (format, frequency)	
29	Confidentiality boundaries set on process data shared externally	
30	Alternative market options assessed (where EU exposure is marginal)	

E. Systems & Timeline (10)

#	Check	Evidence / Notes
31	Named internal owner for CBAM (single accountable person)	
32	Training delivered to the data-collection team	
33	Metering gaps listed with installation plan	
34	Calculation tool/system in place (not ad-hoc spreadsheets)	
35	Quarterly internal data review scheduled	
36	Registry/trader account status known (via your EU declarant)	
37	2026 declaration obligations understood (first definitive-year cycle)	
38	Phase-out schedule (to 2032) modelled for multi-year exposure	
39	Decarbonisation options screened (each tCO ₂ e cut = certificate cost cut)	

40 Escalation path defined when data gaps appear mid-cycle

SustainSutra GreenTech LLP . CBAM readiness, embedded emissions calculation, verification preparation . director@sustainsutra.in . sustainsutra.in

This checklist is general guidance, not legal advice. Regulation details evolve — verify current requirements on the official EU CBAM portal.